and planning on his part and ready acceptance of his leadership by the conspirators. Verma noted that the USA could have played a major role. This is what he wrote:

The possibility that it was another agency which made available its expertise for the effective planning of the coup and smooth transition of power that took place after the operation was over, cannot be still ruled out completely. There were certain developments, which seem somewhat significant in this regard. Firstly, the fact that no major problems have arisen among the conspirators, military or civilian, following the coup itself points to the existence of a mastermind. Secondly, a military advisory council, with the President as the Chairman and two officers of Major ranks instrumental in the coup, was formed without any loss of time. Thirdly, one of the Major rank officers involved in the coup had taken refuge at the American embassy at Dhaka on 20 August 1975, when he apprehended some danger to himself and the American embassy at Dhaka successfully interceded on his behalf with the army authorities and got certain assurances relating to his safety. The Americans have [had] nothing at all to do with Bangladesh armed forces in the past. This sudden linkage between the American embassy in Dhaka and those in authority on the military side and the ease with which the Americans were able to sort out the problems on behalf of one of the conspirators certainly creates suspicions as to whether the role of the American embassy was more than that of an honest broker.

Within four years of independence, a bias against India had taken deep root in Bangladesh. Mostaq's selection of army and civilian officials reflected that. General Osmani was given the new post of advisor to the defence ministry and Major General Khalilur Rahman, the senior most serving army officer, was